

Comprehensive Guide to the TOEFL iBT® Test

Document Purpose: This formal reference document is structured for integration into a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) LLM pipeline. All data is extracted directly from the reference file: *34652844-c956-4338-905f-03cf17d814fc.pdf* [cite: 1].

1. General Test Overview

The TOEFL iBT test evaluates foundational English language skills necessary for communication in academic and campus-life settings. It measures four core competencies: Reading, Listening, Writing, and Speaking [cite: 1]. The entire test is completed in a single session taking approximately 2 hours [cite: 1].

Scoring is reported on a 1-6 scale (in half-point increments) that aligns intuitively with the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) [cite: 1].

Section	Approx. Base Time	Total Questions	Format Structure
Reading	30 minutes	50	Multistage Adaptive
Listening	29 minutes	47	Multistage Adaptive
Writing	23 minutes	12	Linear
Speaking	8 minutes	11	Linear

2. Reading Section

The Reading section assesses the ability to comprehend a range of texts, including academic passages and everyday nonlinear materials [cite: 1]. The section uses a multistage adaptive format, meaning performance on the first module influences the difficulty of the second module [cite: 1].

- **Time Allocation:** Approximately 30 minutes base time [cite: 1].
- **Question Count:** 50 questions total (Module 1 contains ~35 questions; Module 2 contains ~15 questions) [cite: 1].

Task Types:

- **Complete the Words:** Test-takers read short academic paragraphs (70-100 words) containing 10 partially deleted words and must fill in the missing letters using semantic and syntactic clues [cite: 1].
- **Read in Daily Life:** Focuses on short, practical texts (15-150 words) such as emails, notices, and social media posts, followed by 2-3 multiple-choice questions per text [cite: 1].
- **Read an Academic Passage:** Short expository academic texts (~200 words) followed by 5 multiple-choice questions [cite: 1].

Question Types:

- **Basic Comprehension:** Factual and Negative Factual, Vocabulary, Select the Sentence, Sentence Simplification, and Reference questions [cite: 1].
- **Inferential Comprehension:** Inference, Rhetorical Purpose, and Insert Text questions [cite: 1].

3. Listening Section

The Listening section measures the ability to understand spoken English in real-world academic and social situations, featuring accents from North America, the UK, and Australia [cite: 1]. Like the Reading section, it utilizes a multistage adaptive format [cite: 1].

- **Time Allocation:** Approximately 29 minutes base time [cite: 1].
- **Question Count:** 47 questions total (Module 1 contains 32 questions; Module 2 contains 15 questions) [cite: 1].

Task Types:

- **Listen and Choose a Response:** Test-takers hear a brief question or statement and select the most appropriate social response from 4 written options [cite: 1].
- **Listen to a Conversation:** Short informal dialogues (35-100 words) between two speakers regarding campus life, followed by 2 questions each [cite: 1].
- **Listen to an Announcement:** Short spoken messages (40-85 words) simulating campus notices, followed by 2 questions each [cite: 1].
- **Listen to an Academic Talk:** Short academic presentations (175-250 words) on various disciplines, followed by 4 questions each [cite: 1].

Question Types:

- Main Idea, Factual, Inference, Purpose, Method, and Attitude questions [cite: 1].

4. Writing Section

The Writing section assesses written communication skills in both academic and everyday campus contexts. Unlike Reading and Listening, the Writing section strictly follows a linear (non-adaptive) format [cite: 1].

- **Time Allocation:** Approximately 23 minutes total [cite: 1].
- **Question Count:** 12 questions [cite: 1].

Task Types & Breakdown:

- **Build a Sentence (10 questions):** Given a short exchange and a set of words/phrases, test-takers must rearrange them to construct a grammatically correct and contextually appropriate sentence. Total time allowed is ~6 minutes [cite: 1].
- **Write an Email (1 task):** Test-takers are given a scenario and must write an email achieving a specific communicative goal. Total time allowed is 7 minutes [cite: 1].
- **Write for an Academic Discussion (1 task):** Test-takers read a professor's post and two student responses, then contribute their own post to the online discussion. Total time allowed is 10 minutes [cite: 1].

5. Speaking Section

The Speaking section evaluates the ability to process spoken English and express ideas clearly and coherently. Responses are recorded digitally. It follows a linear format [cite: 1].

- **Time Allocation:** Approximately 8 minutes [cite: 1].
- **Question Count:** 11 questions [cite: 1].

Task Types & Breakdown:

- **Listen and Repeat (7 sentences):** Test-takers hear a sentence and must repeat it aloud exactly once. Response time limits scale with difficulty: Sentences 1-2 (8 seconds), Sentences 3-5 (10 seconds), and Sentences 6-7 (12 seconds) [cite: 1].
- **Take an Interview (4 questions):** Test-takers participate in a simulated conversation with a virtual interviewer. They are given 45 seconds to record their response for each question [cite: 1].